

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- AI-powered defense strategy: How to find and fix vulnerabilities at machine speed
- New Unisoc modem flaw allows Android kernel access
- McDonald's employee records allegedly stolen from Azure
- Internet users increasingly frustrated by AI slop and data leaks
- Critical GitLab Zero-Click Flaw Poses Mitigation Challenges

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Security Hub Extended adds Supply Chain Security as its tenth category

Since February, we've grown AWS Security Hub Extended from 14 curated partners across 9 categories to 23 partners across 10. At Black Hat this month, 14 of those partners were at the Amazon Web Services (AWS) booth demoing live. Four of those partners delivered theater talks and ten were featured on SecurityLive streaming. We hosted [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/security-hub-extended-adds-supply-chain-security-as-its-tenth-category/>

02. NETSCOUT expands Adaptive DDoS Protection with outbound attack mitigation

NETSCOUT has announced an extension of its Adaptive DDoS Protection (ADP) solution enabling service providers to automatically detect and mitigate outbound DDoS attack traffic. By extending protection from the attack target towards its source, NETSCOUT helps operators prevent compromised subscriber devices from disrupting their own networks, consuming costl...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/18/netscout-expands-adaptive-ddos-protection-with-outbound-attack-mitigation/>

03. Silent 'TwinLoot' Cyber Threat Operates Entirely From Microsoft's Cloud

The Python-based malware framework takes living-off-the-land tactics to a new heights of stealth, with a modular implant that steals credentials and achieves persistence.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cloud-security/silent-twinloot-threat-operates-microsoft-cloud>

04. 16 Typosquatted RubyGems Packages Steal Browser Credentials and Crypto Wallets

Cybersecurity researchers have flagged a new typosquatting campaign targeting RubyGems users with a Windows-based information stealer. OpenSourceMalware, which discovered the activity on August 15, 2026, is tracking the threat under the moniker StubMaker. The complete list of packages published as part of the campaign is below -

ubnuler ubnlder ri18nr reake...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/16-typosquatted-rubygems-packages-steal.html>

05. New Malware turns Microsoft cloud into its control center

Security researchers are warning of a newly uncovered Python malware framework that routes much of its command-and-control (C2) activity through Microsoft services that defenders already expect to see. The Ontinue Cyber Defense Center discovered the implant while investigating an active campaign in July and has since tracked it as TWINLOOT. It was seen usin...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4210973/new-malware-turns-microsoft-cloud-into-its-control-center.html>

06. [+24h Old] ISC Stormcast For Tuesday, August 18th, 2026

<https://isc.sans.edu/podcastdetail/10056>, (Tue, Aug 18th)

ISC Stormcast For Tuesday, August 18th, 2026 <https://isc.sans.edu/podcastdetail/10056>, (Tue, Aug 18th)

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33256>

07. [+24h Old] 'Turf War' Between Claude Agents Leads to Self-Replicating Malware

Three testing models with the same goal but different directives engaged in "increasingly aggressive" territorial attacks on one another, according to Anthropic.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/threat-intelligence/turf-war-claude-agents-self-replicating-malware>

08. [+24h Old] Linux Botnet Evo001Bot Expands Mirai Capabilities Well Beyond DDoS

The botnet adds exploitation modules, credential theft, and reverse SOCKS relays to turn compromised devices into persistent attacker infrastructure.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyber-risk/linux-botnet-evooo1bot-mirai-capabilities-beyond-ddos>

09. [+24h Old] Apple Screen Sharing Security, (Mon, Aug 17th)

About 20 years ago, with macOS 10.5 (Leopard), Apple introduced screen sharing. Apple did not invent a new protocol for screen sharing. Instead, it used the established VNC protocol. VNC is a pretty simple, unencrypted protocol using TCP port 5900. Historically, the protocol used a simple global password for authentication. Apple adapted the protocol for it...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33252>

10. [+24h Old] Why data quality dictates security operations success

As AI takes on more security operations center (SOC) workflows to automate threat triage, indicator extraction, and incident report generation, security operations leaders face a persistent question: Does SOC performance depend more on the large language model (LLM) deployed or on the underlying quality of the security data it consumes? Academic studies off...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources:

<https://www.csoonline.com/article/4206800/why-data-quality-dictates-security-operations-success.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. AI-powered defense strategy: How to find and fix vulnerabilities at machine speed

As vulnerability discovery is industrialized, remediation must combine AI automation, environmental context and human expertise.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/resource/ai-powered-defense-strategy-how-to-find-and-fix-vulnerabilities-at-machine-speed>

02. New Unisoc modem flaw allows Android kernel access

Researchers demonstrated this exploit chain on a Realme C33 smartphone, confirming its effectiveness on devices with specific Android security patches.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/new-unisoc-modem-flaw-allows-android-kernel-access>

03. Critical GitLab Zero-Click Flaw Poses Mitigation Challenges

A lack of technical details could make it hard for organizations running self-managed GitLab versions to detect potential exploitation of CVE-2026-19478.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/application-security/critical-gitlab-zero-click-flaw-mitigation-challenges>

04. Implement custom authentication for tools integration using request Lambda interceptor in AgentCore Gateway

When deploying AI agents with Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, organizations benefit from built-in modern support for OAuth 2.0, AWS Identity and Access Management (IAM), and API key authentication through Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Gateway. However, some enterprise environments still use legacy authentication mechanisms such as HTTP Basic Authentication (Basic Auth...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/implement-custom-authentication-for-tools-integration-using-request-lambda-interceptor-in-agentcore-gateway/>

05. Critical GitLab flaw allows attackers to delete and modify public repos

GitLab has fixed a critical vulnerability that could allow unauthenticated attackers to perform unauthorized modifications inside code repositories or to completely delete them with a single HTTP request. The patched releases also address a second high-risk cross-site request forgery (CSRF) flaw. The critical vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-19478 , is de...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4211140/critical-gitlab-flaw-allows-attackers-to-delete-and-modify-public-repos.html>

06. CISOs Break Their Silence in 'Declassified' Docuseries

Million-dollar heists, divorce, and career-ending burnout are all stories told in the latest docuseries revealing a behind-the-scenes look at the cybersecurity community.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyber-risk/cisos-break-their-silence-in-declassified-docuseries>

07. CVE-2026-68820 is in KEV. Here Is What CISA BOD 26-04 Actually Requires Now

Executive Summary CVE-2026-68820 is an actively exploited Windows vulnerability listed in CISA's Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) Catalog, with a remediation deadline as suggested by CISA BOD 26-04. CISA BOD 26-04 introduces risk-based remediation timelines ranging from 3 to 14 days, increasing the pressure on teams to move quickly from patch availabil...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://blog.qualys.com/product-tech/2026/08/18/cve-2026-68820-kev-bod-26-04-requirements>

08. Attackers Exploit MLflow SSRF Flaw to Steal Cloud Credentials and Secrets

Two critical vulnerabilities impacting MLflow, an open-source artificial intelligence (AI) platform, and FUXA, an open-source, web-based SCADA / HMI software built for operational technology (OT) and industrial automation, are witnessing malicious scanning and exploitation efforts. According to independent reports from watchTowr and VulnCheck, the vulnerabi...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/attackers-exploit-mlflow-ssrf-flaw-to.html>

09. CISA gives feds 3 days to fix actively exploited Ray RCE bug

Phishing, malvertising attacks could target devs to gain access to private corporate networks

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/18/cisa-gives-feds-3-days-to-fix-actively-exploited-ray-rce-bug/5289007>

10. Enterprise Applications Carry 4.31x More Critical and High Vulnerabilities

Enterprise software creation has accelerated as vulnerability levels rise, Sonatype finds

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/enterprise-apps-critical-high/>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. McDonald's employee records allegedly stolen from Azure

The seller, operating under the name TheHatman, advertised the data dump, titled "McDonalds 1.7M+ Azure Internal Employee Dump," on a forum.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/mcdonalds-employee-records-allegedly-stolen-from-azure>

02. Internet users increasingly frustrated by AI slop and data leaks

A recent survey by Incogni reveals that over half of internet users believe their personal data will inevitably be exposed, leading to anxiety for 63% of respondents.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/internet-users-increasingly-frustrated-by-ai-slop-and-data-leaks>

03. Threat Brief: Mitigating Large-Scale Credential Attacks (Updated August 18)

In August 2026, the actor TheHatman claimed to have stolen large volume of credentials from organizations' Microsoft Entra tenants. We provide guidance on mitigating large-scale credential attacks. The post Threat Brief: Mitigating Large-Scale Credential Attacks (Updated August 18) appeared first on Unit 42 .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/large-scale-credential-attacks/>

04. Clop created custom web shell for Windchill data theft attacks

A custom Java web shell likely linked to the Clop ransomware gang was designed specifically for PTC Windchill and FlexPLM servers, with built-in features to decrypt credentials, enumerate file repositories, and steal files. [...]

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/clop-created-custom-web-shell-for-windchill-data-theft-attacks/>

05. Ransom Busters Claims It Hacked Ransomware Servers, Asks Victims for Up to \$60,000

A ransomware affiliate calling itself Ransom Busters has been spotted proactively sending emails to victim organizations and claims to delete stolen data from ransomware groups' servers in exchange for a fee ranging from \$20,000 to \$60,000. "In these messages, the third-party offers to help the victim recover from ransomware attack. This immediately stands...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/ransom-busters-claims-it-hacked.html>

06. Thousands of Hacked WordPress Sites, One Operation: Unmasking StopAndProtect

Research by: Jaromír Hořejší (@JaromirHorejsi) Key points Introduction We first noticed a ransomware family called StopAndProtect in the middle of May 2026. Further analysis of the infrastructure reveals that the infection chain starts with a ClickFix social-engineering technique, which prompts victims to execute a PowerShell command. This leads to two stag...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/thousands-of-hacked-wordpress-sites-one-operation-unmasking-stopandprotect/>

07. 'Ransom Busters': Ransomware Actor Poses as Incident-Recovery Service

A ransomware affiliate appears to be sidling up to victims with offers of aid, masking its true intention of diverting ransom payments.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyberattacks-data-breaches/ransom-busters-ransomware-actor-incident-recovery-service>

08. Heights Finance data breach: What customers need to know

Leaked personal and financial data of around 750,000 US citizens, including SSNs and bank details, could put victims at risk of identity theft and phishing.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/data-breaches/2026/08/heights-finance-data-breach-what-customers-need-to-know>

09. Three-quarters of Ransomware Attacks Target Mid-Market Firms

Black Kite finds mid-market is the sweet spot for ransomware as manufacturers are most likely to be hit

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/threequarters-ransomware-attacks/>

10. [+24h Old] OpenAI tightens defenses after AI agents breach research environment

Following the OpenAI-Hugging Face incident, in which an agentic collective autonomously penetrated OpenAI's research infrastructure and another company's production infrastructure by chaining together multiple weaknesses, OpenAI began strengthening its safety requirements. The weaknesses included previously unknown vulnerabilities and credentials leaked onl...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/18/openai-strengthening-security-measures/>